Engine of growth	Paid	Viral
Registration rate	42%	51%
Activation	83%	92%
Retention	21%	28%
Referral	54%	64%
Revenue	1%	11%
Lifetime value (LTV)	Minimal	$0.20 per message

Votizen's story exhibits some common patterns. One of the most important to note is the acceleration of MVPs. The first MVP took eight months, the next four months, then three, then one. Each time David was able to validate or refute his next hypothesis faster than before.

How can one explain this acceleration? It is tempting to credit it to the product development work that had been going on. Many features had been created, and with them a fair amount of infrastructure. Therefore, each time the company pivoted, it didn't have to start from scratch. But this is not the whole story. For one thing, much of the product had to be discarded between pivots. Worse, the product that remained was classified as a legacy product, one that was no longer suited to the goals of the company. As is usually the case, the effort required to reform a legacy product took extra work. Counteracting these forces were the hard-won lessons David had learned through each milestone. Votizen accelerated its MVP process because it was learning critical things about its customers, market, and strategy.

Today, two years after its inception, Votizen is doing well. They recently raised $1.5 million from Facebook's initial investor Peter Thiel, one of the very few consumer Internet investments he has made in recent years. Votizen's system now can process voter identity in real time for forty-seven states representing 94 percent of